LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING

# Daily 2026-11-05 Ivanti Connect Secure CVE-2026-111357 Exploitation Priority Revalidation

CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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|---|---|
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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | Daily 2026-11-05 Ivanti Connect Secure CVE-2026-111357 Exploitation Priority Revalidation - CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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# Daily 2026-11-05 Ivanti Connect Secure CVE-2026-111357 Exploitation Priority Revalidation

## 1. Executive Summary

CVE-2026-111357 is an Ivanti Connect Secure (ICS) privilege-escalation component that CISA added to the Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV) Catalog on 2026-10-30. CISA's current alert states that it was exploited as part of a chain with CVE-2026-104935 and CVE-2026-118527. Internet-facing ICS appliances must be treated as a high-priority incident-response and patch-validation population.

This report does not characterize CVE-2026-111357 as a standalone unauthenticated entry point. Ivanti's advisory is the authority for chain preconditions, affected builds, and fixed releases. The operational priority is to inventory exposed appliances, apply vendor guidance, run the Integrity Checker Tool, preserve relevant evidence, and assume that successful chain use could yield appliance-level privilege.

## 2. Daily Revalidation Note

On 2026-11-05 UTC, Lost Boys Cyber revalidated this priority against the current CISA KEV JSON feed and retained it in the daily priority set because CISA still lists the CVE as a known exploited vulnerability added on 2026-10-30. This is a date-stamped operational revalidation, not evidence of a newly disclosed vulnerability, a newly observed victim, or a change to Ivanti fixed-version guidance.

## 3. Vulnerability Metadata

| Field | Value |
|---|---|
| CVE | CVE-2026-111357 |
| Product | Ivanti Connect Secure |
| CISA weakness label | Missing Authentication for Critical Function |
| Role in reported activity | Privilege-escalation component in a reported chained exploitation sequence |
| KEV status | Added 2026-10-30 |
| Exploitation status | CISA and Ivanti describe limited customer impact when the related CVEs are chained |
| Primary remediation | Apply Ivanti's current fixed release guidance and validate appliance integrity |
| Important limitation | Do not infer independent unauthenticated exploitation from the KEV entry alone |

## 4. Source Review & Confidence

| Source | Contribution | Confidence |
|---|---|---|
| CISA KEV catalog | Current priority and date of KEV addition | High |
| CISA Ivanti alert | Exploited-chain and immediate-action context | High |
| Ivanti security advisory | Product scope, fixed-release and integrity- | High |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | check guidance | |
| Ivanti October security update | Vendor operational remediation reinforcement | High |

The KEV listing establishes prioritization, not every technical prerequisite. No exploit reproduction was performed. Claims about full compromise, actor attribution, or a specific appliance's exposure require environment-specific evidence.

## 5. Vulnerability Details

CISA labels the issue as a missing-authentication critical-function weakness. Current public guidance places it in an exploitation chain involving related ICS flaws. Connect Secure commonly serves as a remote-access trust boundary; appliance compromise can therefore endanger VPN authentication, administrative access, session material, and downstream internal reachability. Treat the appliance and its management plane as security-critical infrastructure.

## 6. Attack Scenarios

| Scenario | Preconditions | Potential outcome | Priority action |
|---|---|---|---|
| Reported chained exploitation | Vulnerable ICS and documented related chain conditions | Elevated appliance privileges | Patch, run integrity checks, and investigate |
| Appliance compromise followed by VPN abuse | Access to appliance controls, sessions, or credentials | Lateral movement through remote-access trust | Review authentication, admin, and VPN telemetry |
| Delayed remediation | Externally reachable vulnerable appliance remains online | Continued scanning/exploitation opportunity | Restrict exposure during maintenance |

## 7. Affected Products and Exposure

| Exposure pattern | Why it matters | Required action |
|---|---|---|
| Public ICS gateway | Direct exposure to a KEV-listed chain component | Identify version; follow Ivanti remediation immediately |
| ICS behind approved remote access | Reduced exposure but still a trust boundary | Patch on emergency schedule and review authentication events |
| Retired but reachable appliance | Often lacks patch ownership and monitoring | Isolate or decommission; validate DNS and firewall records |
| HA cluster / DR appliance | Drift can leave a vulnerable failover path | Validate every node and test failover after patching |

## 8. Mitigation and Workarounds

| Priority | Owner | Action | Verification |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical | Network / IAM | Inventory every ICS appliance, role, version, and internet exposure | Signed inventory and firewall review |
| Critical | Platform | Apply the Ivanti advisory's fixed-release guidance | Version and maintenance record |
| Critical | Incident response | Run the Ivanti Integrity | Tool output retained with case |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | Checker Tool and preserve alerts/logs | evidence |
| High | SOC | Review administrative, authentication, configuration, and outbound-network activity | Hunt results documented |
| High | IAM | Rotate privileged appliance/admin credentials when integrity concerns exist | Rotation audit complete |

## 9. Detection Engineering

| Signal | Telemetry source | Analytic goal |
|---|---|---|
| New or unusual ICS administrator activity | ICS audit / identity logs | Identify management-plane manipulation |
| Authentication successes from novel networks | VPN / IdP logs | Identify abnormal remote-access use |
| Appliance-originated outbound traffic | Firewall, proxy, NetFlow | Identify unexpected callbacks or staging |

```
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where DeviceName has_any ("ivanti", "ics", "pulse")
| where InitiatingProcessFileName !in~ ("", "expected-management-agent")
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP, RemotePort, InitiatingProcessFileName
| order by Timestamp desc
```

```
index=vpn (sourcetype=ivanti* OR host=*ics*)
| stats count values(user) as users values(src_ip) as source_ips by action, dest, _time
| sort - _time
```

## 10. Threat Hunting

**Hypothesis:** a vulnerable or previously exposed ICS appliance was used to alter access controls or enable suspicious remote-access activity after chain exploitation.

```
SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(30d)
| where AppDisplayName has_any ("Ivanti", "Connect Secure", "VPN")
| summarize users=dcount(UserPrincipalName), ips=make_set(IPAddress, 20),
resultCodes=make_set(ResultType, 10) by bin(TimeGenerated, 1h), AppDisplayName
| where users > 5 or array_length(ips) > 10
| order by TimeGenerated desc
```

Triage results by correlating source IPs with ICS audit changes, appliance integrity-check results, and privileged-group modifications. A detection hit is investigation evidence, not proof of exploitation.

## 11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

| Technique | Name | Rationale |
|---|---|---|
| T1190 | Exploit Public-Facing Application | Relevant to exposed remote-access appliances and the reported chain |
| T1068 | Exploitation for Privilege Escalation | Relevant to the reported privilege-escalation component |
| T1098 | Account Manipulation | Hunt for access or admin changes after suspected compromise |

## 12. Validation / Lab Testing

No exploit reproduction or intrusive appliance testing was performed. QA verified the CISA KEV entry, CISA alert, vendor remediation framing, structured tables, embedded KQL/SPL queries, PDF rendering, and extracted text. Operators must validate actual installed versions and maintenance outcomes under approved change control.

## 13. Recommended Actions Summary

| Priority | Action |
|---|---|
| 1 | Treat internet-facing ICS as an emergency inventory and remediation target. |
| 2 | Apply Ivanti's fixed-release guidance to every production, HA, DR, and management-plane node. |
| 3 | Run the Integrity Checker Tool and preserve its output before and after remediation. |
| 4 | Hunt for anomalous remote access, appliance administration, and outbound communication; rotate credentials if compromise indicators exist. |

## 14. References


- [1] CISA, Known Exploited Vulnerabilities Catalog. https://www.cisa.gov/sites/default/files/feeds/known_exploited_vulnerabilities.json
- [2] CISA, Urges Patching Newly Exploited Vulnerabilities in Ivanti Connect Secure. https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2026/10/13/cisa-urges-patching-newly-exploited-vulnerabilities-ivanti-connect-secure
- [3] Ivanti, Security Advisory Ivanti Connect Secure (CVE-2026-104935). https://hub.ivanti.com/s/article/Security-Advisory-Ivanti-Connect-Secure-CVE-2026-104935
- [4] Ivanti, October 2026 Security Update. https://www.ivanti.com/blog/october-2026-security-update